

Practice file answer key

Unit 1

Working with words

Exercise 1

2 a 3 f 4 d 5 e 6 c

Exercise 2

2 trustworthy 3 ineffective
4 functional 5 successful
6 wary

Exercise 3

1 rapport 2 creativity
3 professionalism 4 innovation
5 tradition 6 principles

Business communication skills

Exercise 1

- 1 I'm calling about ...
- 2 responding so quickly
- 3 I wondered if you'd
- 4 I suggest we meet to
- 5 would you like to meet
- 6 Let's say
- 7 Whatever's best
- 8 in from France, won't you
- 9 Can you tell me how
- 10 Let me know where
- 11 I'll email you a map
- 12 See you

Exercise 2

- 1 My name's James Sims and I work for UB.
- 2 I was given your details by Jill Sander.
- 3 I wanted to see if you are still interested in our offer.
- 4 Is it best by taxi or public transport?
- 5 I'll get my assistant to call you later today to confirm.

Language at work

Exercise 1

- 1 buys, sells
- 2 goes
- 3 does the last flight to New York leave
- 4 's taking
- 5 's having
- 6 'm seeing
- 7 get back
- 8 're developing

Exercise 2

Example answers

- 2 What does he look like?
- 3 Do you prefer tea or coffee?
- 4 What does it taste like?
- 5 Who does this belong to?
- 6 Do you own your apartment?

Exercise 3

- 1 catch 2 'm designing
- 3 'm staying 4 complete
- 5 check

Unit 2

Working with words

Exercise 1

1 b 2 b 3 a 4 c
5 a 6 b 7 b 8 c

Exercise 2

2 appreciation 3 incentive
4 bonus 5 morale
6 commission 7 fulfilment
8 loyalty

Business communication skills

Exercise 1

2 e 3 d 4 l 5 j 6 f 7 h
8 c 9 i 10 k 11 g 12 a

Exercise 2

- 1 I don't think we've met.
- 2 Nice to meet you.
- 3 What a coincidence!
- 4 Apparently
- 5 Really?
- 6 Well
- 7 So
- 8 Catch you later.

Language at work

Exercise 1

- 1 Is anyone coming in tomorrow?
- 2 How much could we save?
- 3 What are you talking about?
- 4 Who did you come with?
- 5 How long have you been working with Diana for?
- 6 Who did you send to the exhibition?
- 7 Hasn't Guy gone to the conference?
- 8 Should we ask our manager for help?

Exercise 2

- 1 Why **didn't you** come to me for help?
- 2 How much **does a new one cost**?
- 3 Don't **you work** for MT Electrics?
- 4 What **will you** do first?
- 5 How long **have you been** working for Cisco?
- 6 Who **did you** see at the sales meeting?
- 7 What **does** 'This program has performed an illegal operation' **mean**?
- 8 What **does UNESCO stand for**?

Exercise 3

- 1 aren't you 2 could you
- 3 doesn't it 4 did you
- 5 have you 6 will you
- 7 have they 8 was it

Unit 3

Working with words

Exercise 1

- 2 ran out of money
- 3 were ahead of schedule
- 4 allocating funds
- 5 resolve conflicts
- 6 prioritize tasks
- 7 miss the deadline
- 8 keep track of

Exercise 2

- 1 keep 2 make
- 3 runs 4 check
- 5 stay 6 set

Hidden word = perhaps

Business communication skills

Exercise 1

1 b 2 d 3 c 4 d
5 a 6 c 7 b 8 a

Exercise 2

1 d 2 c 3 g 4 f
5 b 6 h 7 e 8 a

Language at work

Exercise 1

- 1 's decided
- 2 've already spoken
- 3 did you see
- 4 called
- 5 did he say
- 6 hasn't made
- 7 haven't arrived
- 8 Have you finalized
- 9 've fixed
- 10 spoke
- 11 Have you arranged
- 12 've just organized
- 13 booked
- 14 've been

Exercise 2

1 c 2 a 3 d 4 e 5 f 6 b

Unit 4

Working with words

Exercise 1

- 1 set up 2 bring down
- 3 come up with 4 taken up
- 5 carried out 6 pay off
- 7 got round 8 taking forwards

Exercise 2

- 1 revolutionary 2 practical
- 3 features 4 technology
- 5 state-of-the-art 6 advantage
- 7 potential

Practice file answer key

Business communication skills

Exercise 1

- 2 a 3 e 4 c 5 j 6 b
7 d 8 h 9 i 10 f

Exercise 2

- whereas
- The other major advantage
- is another great thing about
- At the moment
- This means
- The biggest potential benefit of
- in the future

Language at work

Exercise 1

- can / will be able to
- be able to
- haven't been able to
- can
- can
- be able to
- can't / won't be able to
- can't
- Has she been able to
- can

Exercise 2

- | | |
|--------------------|------------------|
| 1 could | 2 did you manage |
| 3 was able to | 4 was able to |
| 5 were you able to | 6 couldn't |
| 7 managed to | 8 Were you able |

Unit 5

Working with words

Exercise 1

- | | |
|----------------|----------------|
| 1 repeat | 2 sub-standard |
| 3 discourteous | 4 dissatisfied |
| 5 loyal | 6 high-quality |
| 7 responsive | 8 existing |
| 9 efficient | 10 attentive |

Exercise 2

- 1 b 2 a 3 c 4 b
5 b 6 c 7 a

Business communication skills

Exercise 1

- How can I help you
- Could you explain exactly what the problem is
- Let me get this straight
- by tomorrow
- Could you give me
- Once I've looked into it I'll call you back
- You mean
- in time for the

Exercise 2

- What can I do **for you**?
- If I understand you **correctly** ...
- I'll look **into** it straightaway.
- We need the goods in time **for** ...
- ... I'll get **back to you**.
- ... by Friday **at** the latest.

Language at work

Exercise 1

- Do you know why **he left** the company?
- Could you let me know if **Sam is** working today?
- Correct
- Could you tell me who **you spoke** to?
- Do you know if **the meeting has** started?
- Correct
- Do you know whether **we can** leave early today?
- Could you tell me where **the information office is**?

Exercise 2

- Do you think he will take the job?
- Could you find out when Amanda sent them the catalogue?
- Do you know if this is the train for Munich?
- Do you know where the bus for Place de la Concorde goes from?
- Could you tell me if / whether you have had anything from the minibar?
- Do you know who left this package here?
- I'd be grateful if you could tell me what time you'll be arriving.
- Please let us know if you have any special dietary requirements.

Unit 6

Working with words

Exercise 1

- 1 d 2 f 3 c 4 e
5 g 6 a 7 b

Exercise 2

- | | |
|---------------|------------------|
| 1 Ethical | 2 responsible |
| 3 credibility | 4 generosity |
| 5 fairness | 6 discrimination |
| 7 prejudice | 8 bribery |
| 9 corruption | 10 deception |

Business communication skills

Exercise 1

- 2 i 3 b 4 d 5 a 6 e
7 j 8 c 9 h 10 f

Exercise 2

- We're going to provide you
- You'll get the opportunity to
- is well worth a visit
- It would be a good idea to
- We'd like to invite you to
- It's just the kind of thing we need
- Alternatively, we'd be delighted to show you

Language at work

Exercise 1

Incorrect answers are:

- | | |
|---------------------|--------------------|
| 1 I-see- | 2 I'll-take- |
| 3 I'll-meet | 4 they're-falling- |
| 5 We'll-lose- | 6 I'm-being- |
| 7 I'm-going-to-get- | |

Exercise 2

- 'm going to pick up
- will
- 'm seeing
- 'll take
- 'll make sure
- 're going to go back
- Are you staying
- aren't flying
- are you getting
- leaves
- only takes
- 'll have

Unit 7

Working with words

Exercise 1

- | | |
|--------------|----------------|
| 1 indecisive | 2 conventional |
| 3 outgoing | 4 impulsive |
| 5 determined | 6 methodical |
| 7 creative | 8 thoughtful |

Exercise 2

- | | |
|---------------|--------------|
| 1 perspective | 2 consider |
| 3 weigh up | 4 between |
| 5 rely | 6 confidence |
| 7 delay | |

Business communication skills

Exercise 1

- They're here in black and white ...
- I think it would be crazy to ...
- If you ask me, we should ...
- Could you give us some detail, please?
- Hang on, let's hear what Clare has to say.
- What John says is right.
- If we look at the facts, we'll see ...

Exercise 2

- Today, I'd like to
- what's your position
- As far as I'm concerned
- I don't think we
- The fact is
- what you're getting at is
- I'm not convinced
- it'll mean we
- that's my view
- In other words
- Let's draw up some action points
- I don't want to spend too long

Language at work

Exercise 1

- | | |
|-------------------|----------------|
| table | furniture |
| hotel room | accommodation |
| week | time |
| letter | correspondence |
| computer program | software |
| fax / photocopier | equipment |
| lesson | training |
| euro | money |

Practice file answer key

Exercise 2

- | | |
|---------|----------|
| 1 is | 2 were |
| 3 don't | 4 is |
| 5 has | 6 aren't |
| 7 was | 8 is |

Exercise 3

- | | |
|------------------|-------------------|
| 1 more | 2 a |
| 3 is very little | 4 too many |
| 5 very few | 6 some |
| 7 a little | 8 a morning paper |

Unit 8

Working with words

Exercise 1

- | | |
|--------------|------------|
| 1 activities | 2 process |
| 3 employment | 4 facility |
| 5 workers | 6 growth |
| 7 location | |

Exercise 2

- leads to job losses
- improved the quality of life for
- take cost-cutting measures
- streamline our operation
- free up resources
- created 980 new jobs
- gain a competitive edge

Business communication skills

Exercise 1

- | | |
|-------------------------|-------------------|
| 1 data | 2 has resulted in |
| 3 look at | 4 move on |
| 5 Due | 6 notice on |
| 7 a result | 8 looked at |
| 9 turn our attention to | 10 the facts |
| 11 Have a | 12 leave |

Exercise 2

- | | | | | |
|------|------|------|------|--------|
| 1 to | 2 of | 3 to | 4 at | 5 in |
| 6 on | 7 to | 8 of | 9 to | 10 for |

Language at work

Exercise 1

- All my important files have been lost.
- my flat had been broken into
- to be promoted
- being told
- Our computer system must have been hacked into.
- we are not being told
- I'm being sent
- the chairs were being put away
- Microsoft's new operating system was unveiled
- will the Olympic Village be used

Exercise 2

- accuses
- are paid
- don't recognize
- are often forced
- visited
- was told
- were
- were given

- made
- was packed
- have had
- have been made
- have always produced
- have benefited
- will be raised
- 'll get
- 'll keep up
- will finally be done

Unit 9

Working with words

Exercise 1

- | | | | |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|
| 1 h | 2 f | 3 a | 4 d |
| 5 g | 6 c | 7 e | 8 b |

Exercise 2

- | | |
|------------|------------|
| 1 retain | 2 resource |
| 3 redeploy | 4 appoint |
| 5 mobility | 6 invest |
| 7 key | 8 promote |

Hidden word = turnover

Business communication skills

Exercise 1

- | | | | | |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|------|
| 1 c | 2 b | 3 d | 4 c | 5 d |
| 6 b | 7 a | 8 c | 9 d | 10 b |

Exercise 2

- The areas we need to discuss are
- One option would be to
- Why don't we take on
- So who have we got so far?
- That sounds like a plan

Language at work

Exercise 1

- | | |
|---------------|-----------------|
| 1 comes, will | 2 wanted, would |
| 3 were, would | 4 would, had |
| 5 will, give | 6 would, spoke |
| 7 made, would | 8 want, will |

Exercise 2

- likely situations: 1, 5, 8
- unlikely situations: 2, 3, 4, 6, 7

Exercise 3

- | | |
|------------|----------|
| 1 in case | 2 unless |
| 3 Provided | 4 if |
| 5 As long | |

Exercise 4

Example answers

- I would take a year off.
- I knew I could get my job back.
- I'll go for a ride.
- we'll start without him.

Unit 10

Working with words

Exercise 1

- | | | | | |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|------|
| 1 c | 2 b | 3 a | 4 c | 5 c |
| 6 b | 7 b | 8 c | 9 a | 10 b |

Exercise 2

- | | |
|--------------|--------------|
| 1 totally | 2 a really |
| 3 absolutely | 4 incredibly |
| 5 clever | 6 really |
| 7 impossible | 8 hugely |

Business communication skills

Exercise 1

- What are you doing here?
- I haven't seen you for ages.
- How's life treating you?
- How's business with you?
- ... could you do me a favour?
- The thing is, I'm looking for ...
- That's not something I can decide on right now.
- I'll certainly think about it.

Exercise 2

- | | | | | |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|------|
| 1 j | 2 e | 3 i | 4 c | 5 d |
| 6 b | 7 h | 8 a | 9 g | 10 f |

Language at work

Exercise 1

- 've known
- 's been staying
- has been using
- 've been negotiating
- 've read
- 've been going sailing
- 've had
- have you been waiting
- 've been trying
- 's been raining

Exercise 2

- | | | | | |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|------|
| 1 d | 2 b | 3 g | 4 e | 5 i |
| 6 h | 7 f | 8 c | 9 j | 10 a |

Unit 11

Working with words

Exercise 1

- | | |
|--------|--------|
| 1 with | 2 to |
| 3 on | 4 in |
| 5 on | 6 to |
| 7 to | 8 with |
| 9 with | |

Exercise 2

- | | |
|-----------------|-----------------|
| 1 analyst | 2 analytical |
| 3 communicative | 4 communication |
| 5 participation | 6 participants |
| 7 consultative | 8 consultants |
| 9 transfer | 10 transferable |

Business communication skills

Exercise 1

- | | | | |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|
| 2 a | 3 c | 4 f | 5 d |
| 6 h | 7 e | 8 b | |

Exercise 2

- | | | | | | |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|
| 1 d | 2 a | 3 e | 4 b | 5 f | 6 c |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|-----|

Practice file answer key

Language at work

Exercise 1

- | | |
|-----------|-----------|
| 1 must | 2 must |
| 3 needn't | 4 mustn't |
| 5 needn't | 6 must |
| 7 mustn't | 8 mustn't |
| 9 needn't | |

Exercise 2

- aren't allowed to
- aren't allowed to
- have to
- don't have to
- have to
- don't have to

Unit 12

Working with words

Exercise 1

- try out
- taken on
- putting on
- brought in
- ran into
- dropped out of
- dealt with
- worked out

Exercise 2

- antagonistic towards
- critical of
- ambivalent about
- receptive to
- optimistic about
- concerned about
- enthusiastic about

Business communication skills

Exercise 1

- as you all know
- Starting from February next year
- We'd like to assure you
- we're calling on you to
- we are fairly certain everyone
- You may be wondering
- I'd like to pass this point over to
- let's digress for a moment and

Exercise 2

- Starting from next month we'll be learning
- We're well aware of your concerns regarding
- Over the next few weeks we'll be nominating
- We're also proposing to introduce
- will now deal with
- Later this month we'll be recruiting

Language at work

Exercise 1

- 'll be talking
- 'll have finished
- 'll be analysing
- 'll have produced
- 'll be holding
- will be giving
- won't have agreed
- 'll be visiting
- 'll be attending
- won't have got back

Exercise 2

- I probably won't get the job.
- They are quite likely to cancel the whole order.
- There are certain to be some changes in the final design.
- They are unlikely to accept these terms.
- I might be offered promotion.
- We may face some opposition to these changes.
- If this goes ahead, there will definitely be some job losses.

Unit 13

Working with words

Exercise 1

Answers supplied on page.

Exercise 2

- eighteenth
- forty-eight
- one thousand and ninety-three
- nineteen seventy-two
- five point seven
- three hundred and thirty thousand
- ten to the power of sixth
- a hundred and eighty billion

Exercise 3

- | | |
|-----------------|----------------|
| 1 substantially | 2 levelled |
| 3 gradual | 4 shot |
| 5 approximately | 6 fractionally |
| 7 significant | 8 gradually |
| 9 somewhere | |

Business communication skills

Exercise 1

- | | |
|-------------|-------------|
| 1 speaking | 2 According |
| 3 figures | 4 bottom |
| 5 interpret | 6 low-down |
| 7 general | |

Exercise 2

- Can we look at the figures
- In general
- According to
- What's that in terms of
- Stani assured us that
- Apparently, figures from
- show
- overall things are looking

Language at work

Exercise 1

- the plan would work
- doesn't believe in working at weekends
- to send the letter immediately
- if I'd been waiting long
- they'd had a great time on holiday
- what I thought about the proposal
- a lot of people are unhappy about the changes
- not to let anyone see the plans
- if I'd ever been skiing
- he'd be back on Friday

Exercise 2

- 1 b 2 d 3 a 4 e 5 c 6 f

Exercise 3

- He denied being responsible.
- He encouraged me to apply for the job.
- He refused to let me use his computer.
- He offered to help me.
- He apologized for being late.
- He agreed to lend me the money.

Unit 14

Working with words

Exercise 1

- | | |
|-------------------|-----------------|
| 1 individualistic | 2 liberal |
| 3 egalitarian | 4 hierarchical |
| 5 accepting | 6 cautious |
| 7 formal | 8 strict |
| 9 open | 10 collectivist |

Exercise 2

- | | |
|---------|--------|
| 1 to | 2 of |
| 3 about | 4 with |
| 5 of | 6 to |
| 7 to | 8 of |

Business communication skills

Exercise 1

- in the end
- It came about because of
- That was the first problem
- So what did you do?
- It seems that
- What happened next?
- That was when I felt really uncomfortable
- As time went by

Exercise 2

- At first
- What's more
- It wasn't until
- Despite
- Luckily
- It really surprised me, but it worked.

Practice file answer key

Language at work

Exercise 1

- 1 didn't recognize, 'd changed
- 2 was waiting, called
- 3 was, was raining
- 4 met, was working
- 5 got, 'd left
- 6 arrived, had broken
- 7 jumped, ran, smashed
- 8 noticed, was reading

Exercise 2

- | | |
|--------------------|------------------|
| 1 was doing | 2 went |
| 3 arrived | 4 decided |
| 5 was walking | 6 saw |
| 7 stopped | 8 'd never come |
| 9 didn't know | 10 jumped |
| 11 came | 12 turned |
| 13 ran | 14 looked |
| 15 was racing | 16 was chasing |
| 17 reached | 18 dived |
| 19 looked | 20 was |
| 21 had disappeared | 22 were laughing |

Unit 15

Working with words

Exercise 1

- | | |
|-----------|----------------|
| 1 monitor | 2 conduct |
| 3 address | 4 objective |
| 5 express | 6 constructive |
| 7 agree | |

Exercise 2

- | | |
|---------------|--------------|
| 1 Performance | 2 appraisals |
| 3 tool | 4 criteria |
| 5 value | 6 peer |

Exercise 3

- | | |
|-------|-----------|
| 1 out | 2 through |
| 3 on | 4 across |
| 5 on | 6 with |

Business communication skills

Exercise 1

- | | |
|-------------|------------|
| 1 successes | 2 failures |
| 3 have been | 4 happy |
| 5 improve | 6 best way |
| 7 ought | |

Exercise 2

- 1 Feedback from ...
- 2 How should I do this?
- 3 Can we identify that as
- 4 we could do with some
- 5 you demonstrated good
- 6 ... I wouldn't have organized

Language at work

Exercise 1

- 1 'd bought, would have made
- 2 would have missed, 'd driven
- 3 'd studied, wouldn't need
- 4 had gone, would have shut down
- 5 hadn't brought, wouldn't be talking
- 6 'd packed, would have happened
- 7 'd left, would be
- 8 'd been, would have done

Exercise 2

- 1 You could have been dismissed.
- 2 You could have seen Anne.
- 3 You shouldn't have spoken
- 4 You might have let me know
- 5 You should have sent
- 6 We could have lost
- 7 You might have called

Unit 16

Working with words

Exercise 1

- | | |
|---------------|--------------|
| 1 perspective | 2 appreciate |
| 3 hesitate | 4 tip |
| 5 put off | 6 charity |
| 7 revitalized | |

Exercise 2

- 1 enthusiasm
- 2 Soft
- 3 development
- 4 retention
- 5 broaden
- 6 head off
- 7 policy

Hidden word = holiday

Business communication skills

Exercise 1

- | | | | |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|
| 1 a | 2 c | 3 c | 4 b |
| 5 d | 6 b | 7 d | 8 b |

Exercise 2

- 1 It's been a long-term goal of mine to finish my university course.
- 2 The plus points are skills development and more leadership experience.
- 3 My motivation for this comes from my volunteer work with the Red Cross.
- 4 I'll never be satisfied unless I do it.
- 5 That's hardly fair – I've never refused to do overtime.

Language at work

Exercise 1

- | | |
|------------------|---------------|
| 1 to tell | 2 to do |
| 3 to think | 4 finding |
| 5 to be sent | 6 to oversee |
| 7 to be | 8 to explore |
| 9 letting | 10 to give |
| 11 to keep | 12 taking |
| 13 working | 14 to check |
| 15 collaborating | 16 to discuss |
| 17 hearing | |

Exercise 2

- | | | | |
|-----|-----|-----|-----|
| 1 a | 2 f | 3 c | 4 h |
| 5 d | 6 e | 7 g | 8 b |